i. Organisation of women's groups that would act as a network for channelising the horticultural support;
ii. Need based assessment of women farmers in terms of the horticulture support such as input support, technological support, etc.;
iii. Prioritising the activities of the individual women's groups on the basis of need based assessment;
iv. Providing adequate organisational and financial support to women groups; and
v. Providing technical training in horticulture and allied areas to women-farmers.

15. Animal husbandry has been a significant component of agriculture with an important role in the rural economy. Livestock provide essential animal proteins through milk, meat and eggs; they provide wool and skins; even their excrement is used, directly, as fuel, or, indirectly, in biogias plants.

    The present availability of animal protein in an Indian diet is 10 g per person per day, as against a world average of 25 g. However, keeping in view the growing population, the animal protein availability has to increase at least two-fold for maintaining the nutritional level of growing children and nursing mothers in India.

16. The hot arid regions of India are spread over 31.7 million hectares, 61% of them in West Rajasthan and about 20% in Gujarat; the rest being in Karnataka and Haryana. The cold arid region is in Ladakh where aridity and low temperature limit agricultural season to about five months in a year.

    In the cold arid regions some cereals, oilseeds and fodder crops which mature in a short period and can withstand severe cold are cultivated. The hardy pash- mina goat can also be reared here.

17. About 70% of the 144 million hectares of arable land in India is rainfed and depends on natural precipitation for crop production, and the practice of agriculture here is called dryland or rainfed farming. Dryland agriculture is important for the economy; most of the cereals, pulses, oilseeds and raw cotton are grown on these